

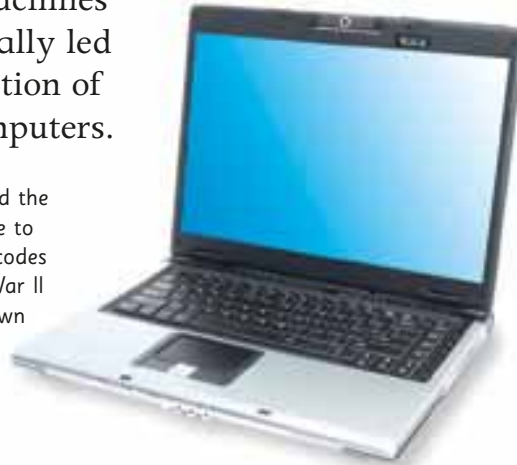
Alan Turing (1912–1954)

During the Second World War, Alan Turing, a brilliant mathematician, helped develop code-breaking machines that eventually led to the invention of modern computers.

The English used the Enigma machine to break German codes during World War II (sometimes known as WWII).



Today's computers are lightweight and portable – early models filled whole rooms.



Computers (1941)

The first computers were huge machines. They couldn't cope with complicated tasks, but worked on only one thing at a time.

Mobile phones (1980s)

Developed from the two-way radios of the 40s and 50s, the first mobiles were large and heavy, weighing about 35 kg (77 lbs) – the same as a 10-year-old child.



Mobile phone

Modern inventions

Imagine the world without these fantastic inventions:



Antibiotics The first antibiotic, penicillin, was discovered accidentally.



Cars Some of the early models were driven by coal or wood-fired engines.



Nuclear power is efficient, but some people think it could harm us.



Plastics technology is used to make many of the things in your home.



Compact disks are small and light, and they store lots of information.



Energy-efficient light bulbs help save energy in your home.

1900

DNA discovered (1953)

The identification of DNA (which holds information in human cells) led to DNA profiling, a huge help to the police – criminals can now be identified by a single hair or spot of blood.

Nuclear bombs (1945)

Sometimes science creates monsters, like the bombs the USA dropped on Japan in WWII. They killed nearly 300,000 people and ended the war.



The internet (1990s)

With its roots in the 1960s, the Internet (short for International Network) became public during the mid 90s, and is now used for fun and education by about 1.5 billion people.

Before DNA profiling, police identified criminals by their fingerprints. This system was developed in the 1890s.

